

SurfaceLayerDiffusivity: first results

First physical comparison | 21 September 2026 | preliminary, diagnostic exclusions apply.

Question: can transport confined to one or two near-wall faces improve coarse LES? Four paired GABLS1 runs use WENO9 at 12.5 m resolution (32^3 cells), a 400 m cube, the same frozen source, and 9 h of integration.

Finding: all three SurfaceLayerDiffusivity variants move the mean u , mean θ and w^2 profiles farther from the fixed 1 m LES median by RMS error over native levels below 200 m. This result applies to this grid and these settings; it is not a general verdict on the closure.

Near-wall response: at 12.5 m, final-hour w^2 falls by 85–93%. Skewness changes from +0.56 in the control to -0.21, -0.25 and -0.42. Domain-integrated resolved TKE falls by 15–20%. The first-face variance is suppressed much more strongly than the integrated energy.

Surface exchange: final-hour u^* rises from 0.279 m/s to 0.292, 0.289 and 0.301 m/s, versus a reference mean of 0.262 m/s. Surface cooling also strengthens, moving farther from the reference. One-face 100 and 300 s responses are similar; two-face support increases local suppression.

Smagorinsky comparison: the earlier 12.5 m WENO9 run ($C_s=0.16$, $Pr=1$) has a final-hour peak w^2 of only $1.12e-6$ m²/s², versus 0.0864 in the control. Its mean- u error is smaller despite almost absent resolved turbulence. Teal curves show this historical context; its source differs from the four matched runs. Log axes reveal the contrast.

Next hypothesis: restrict SLD viscosity to u and v , retaining tracer diffusivity and all other settings. This isolates direct damping of w , but indirect effects through shear and stratification remain. No u/v -only result is included. Single-seed comparisons do not establish uncertainty; the LES median is not observational truth.

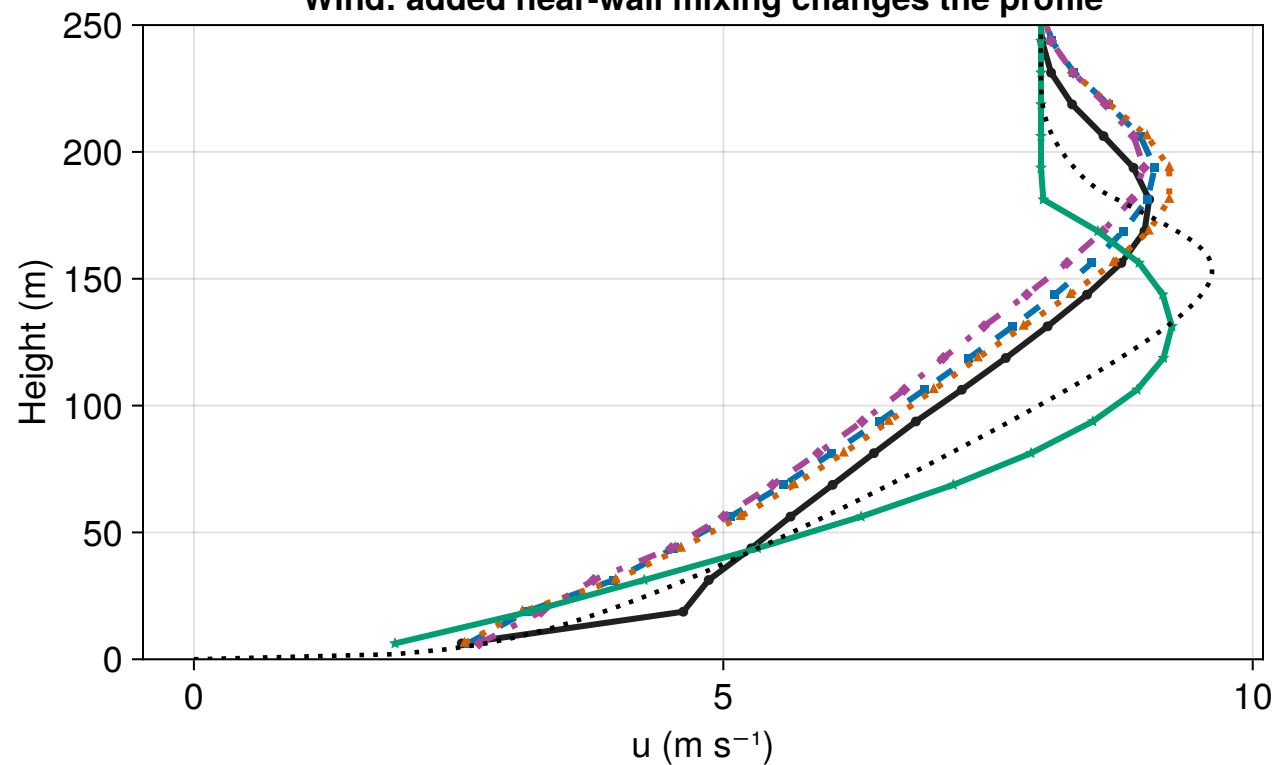
Diagnostic exclusion: SGS flux was incorrectly reported as zero because the generic diagnostic omits the implicit contribution. Combined flux, stress-based depth and dependent budgets are withheld. Mean fields, resolved moments/energy and direct wall exchange remain usable. The model does apply implicit transport. Correct transport diagnostics are the next validation step.

Reading the figures: native-height profiles are true 8–9 h means; timelines use instantaneous output. Colors, line styles and markers distinguish cases. Exact data, Julia source, reference hashes and diagnostic exclusions accompany this brief; all original DYCOMS/GABLS1 report material is retained.

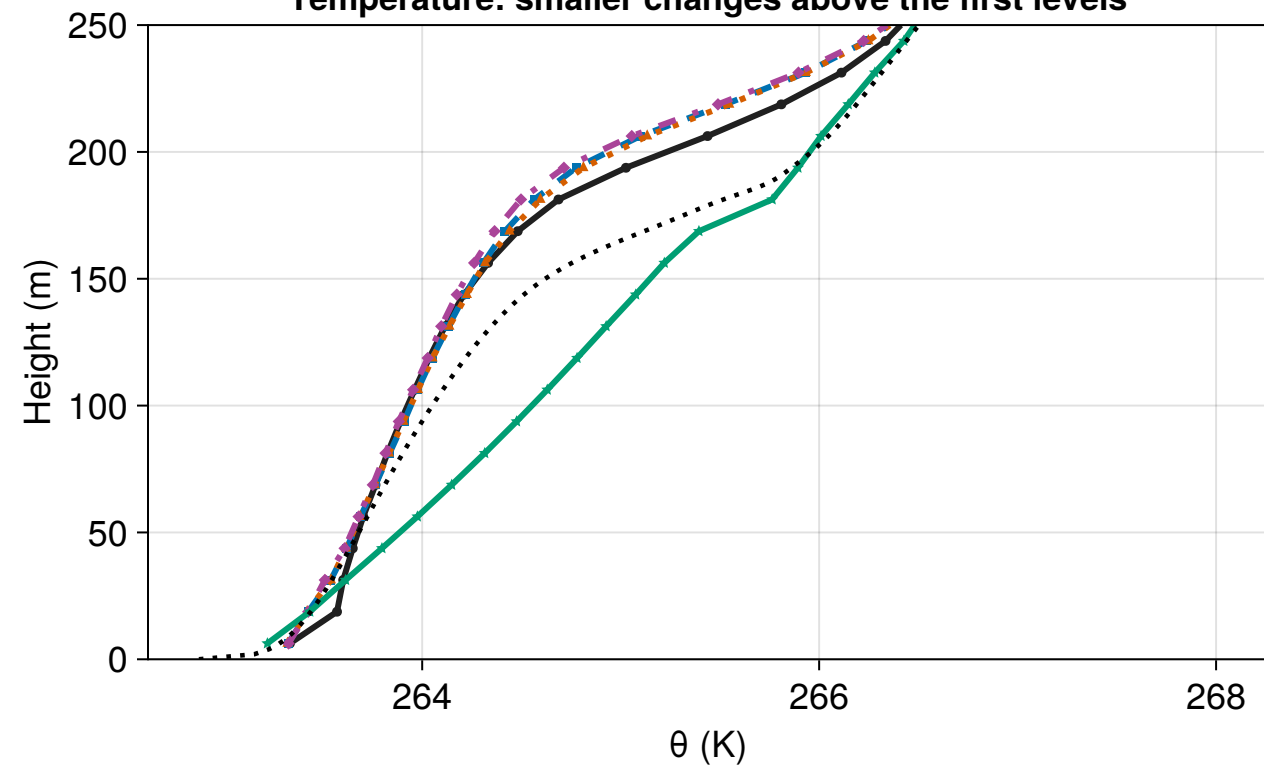
Surface-layer mixing versus coarse-grid Smagorinsky

GABLS1 · WENO9 · 12.5 m grid (32^3) · final hour, 8–9 h · four matched runs + earlier Smagorinsky

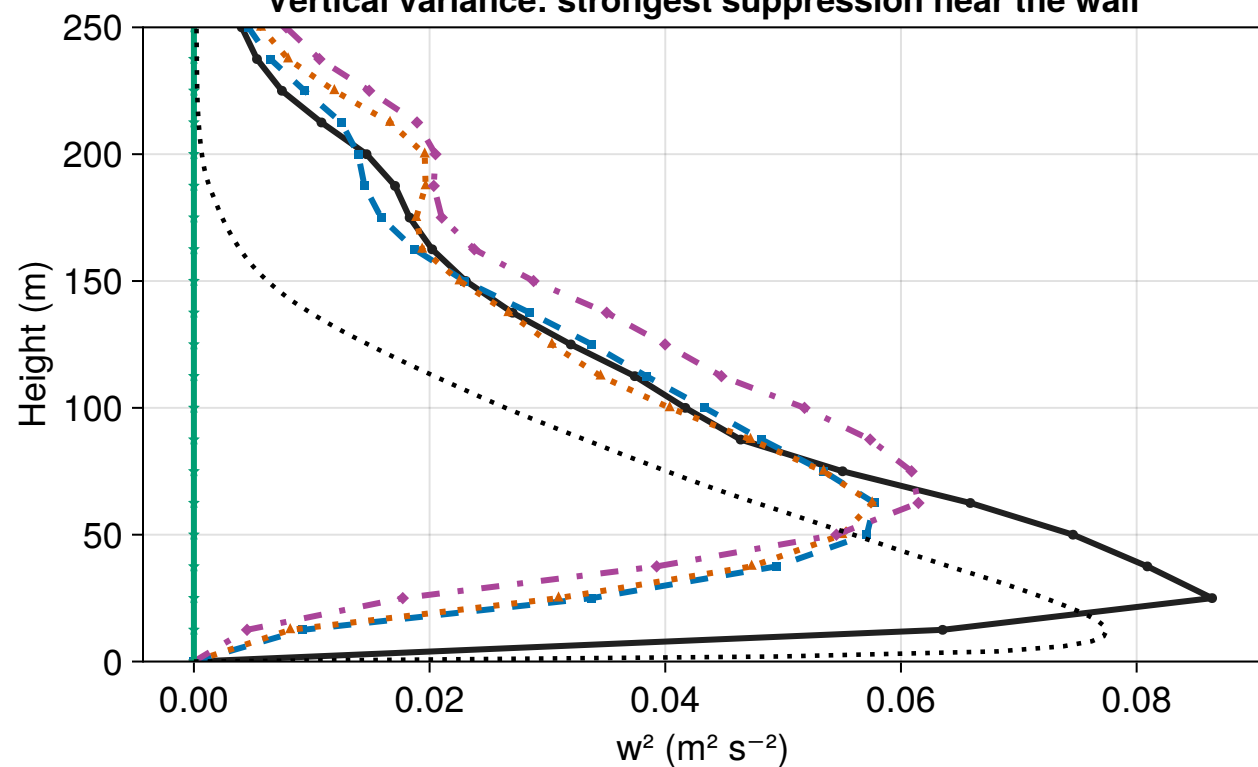
Wind: added near-wall mixing changes the profile



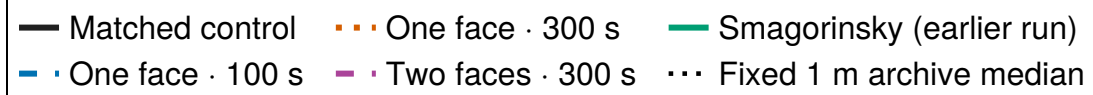
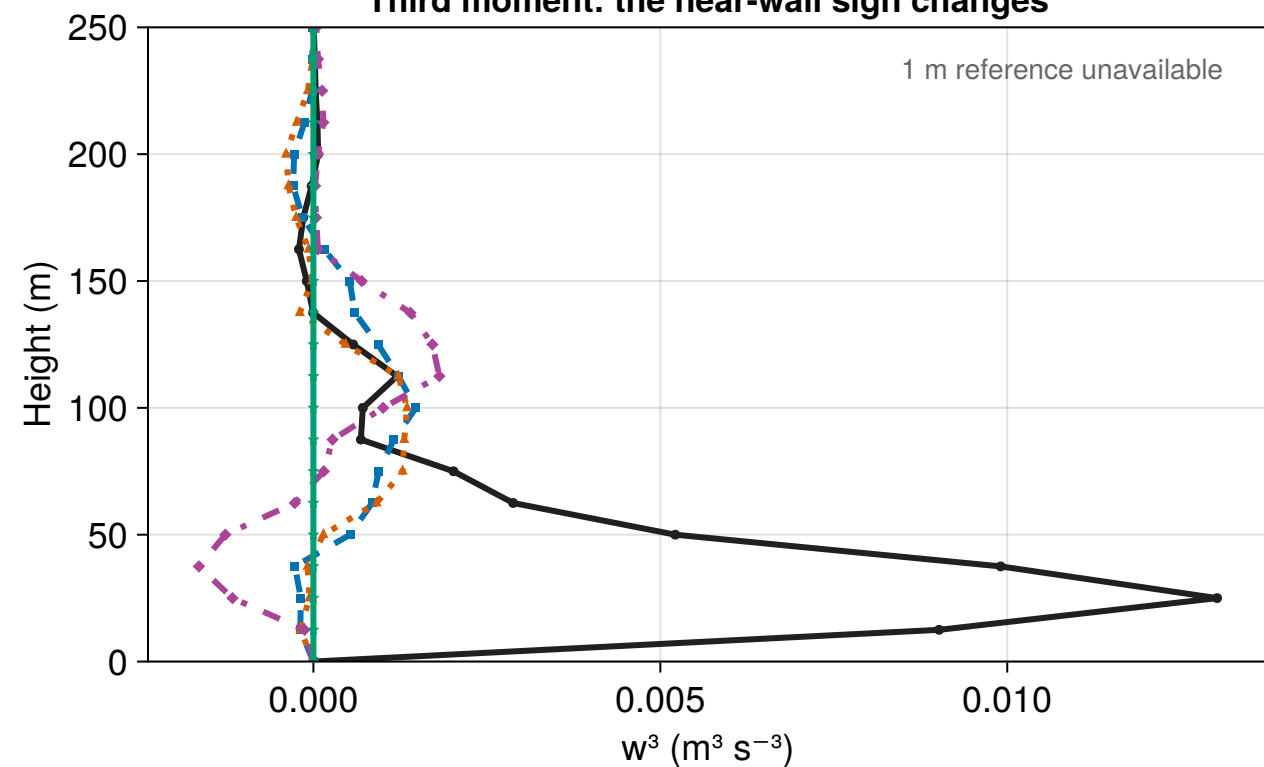
Temperature: smaller changes above the first levels



Vertical variance: strongest suppression near the wall



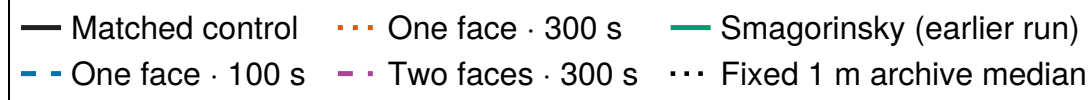
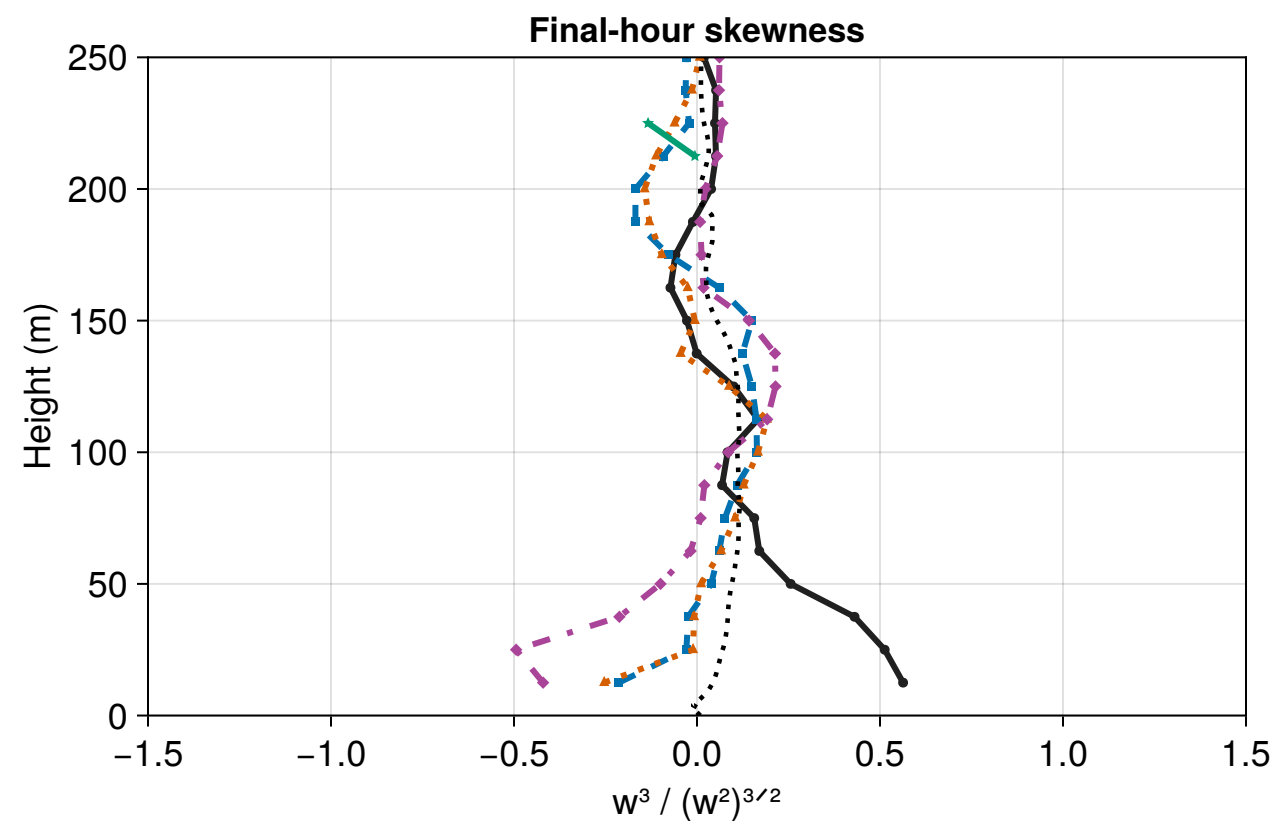
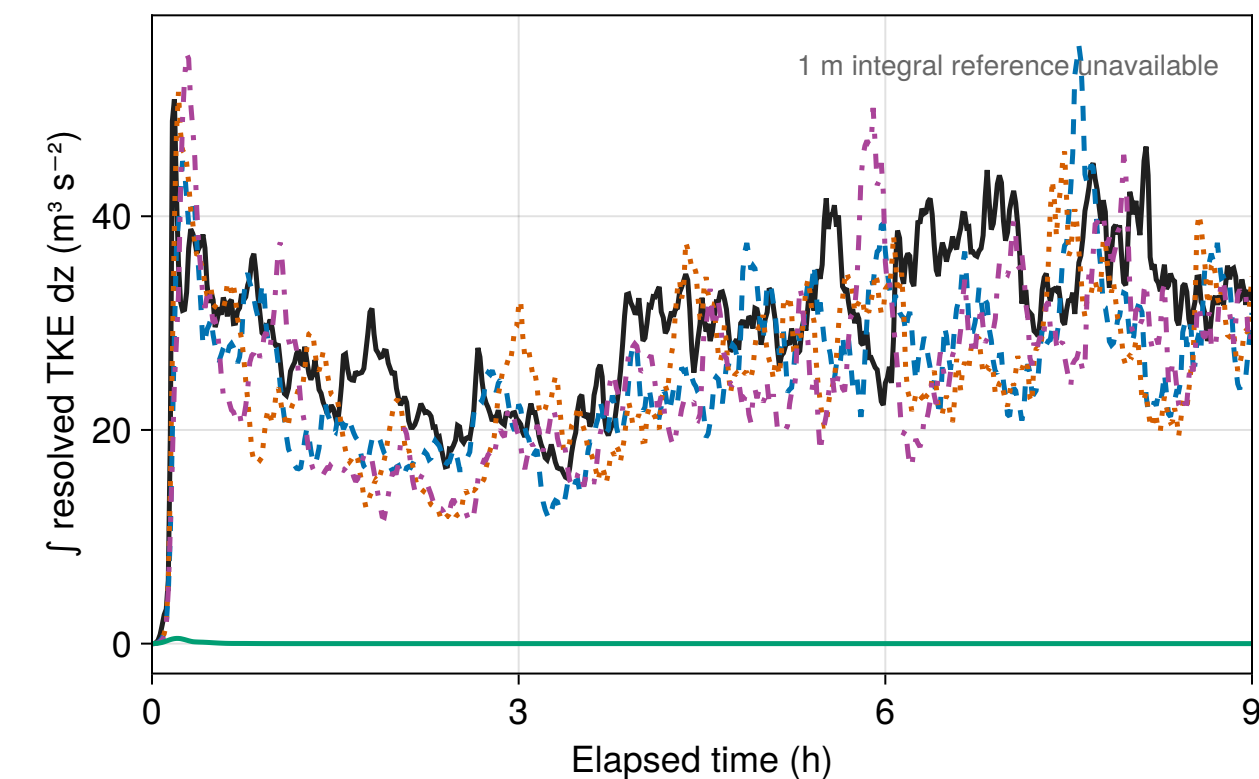
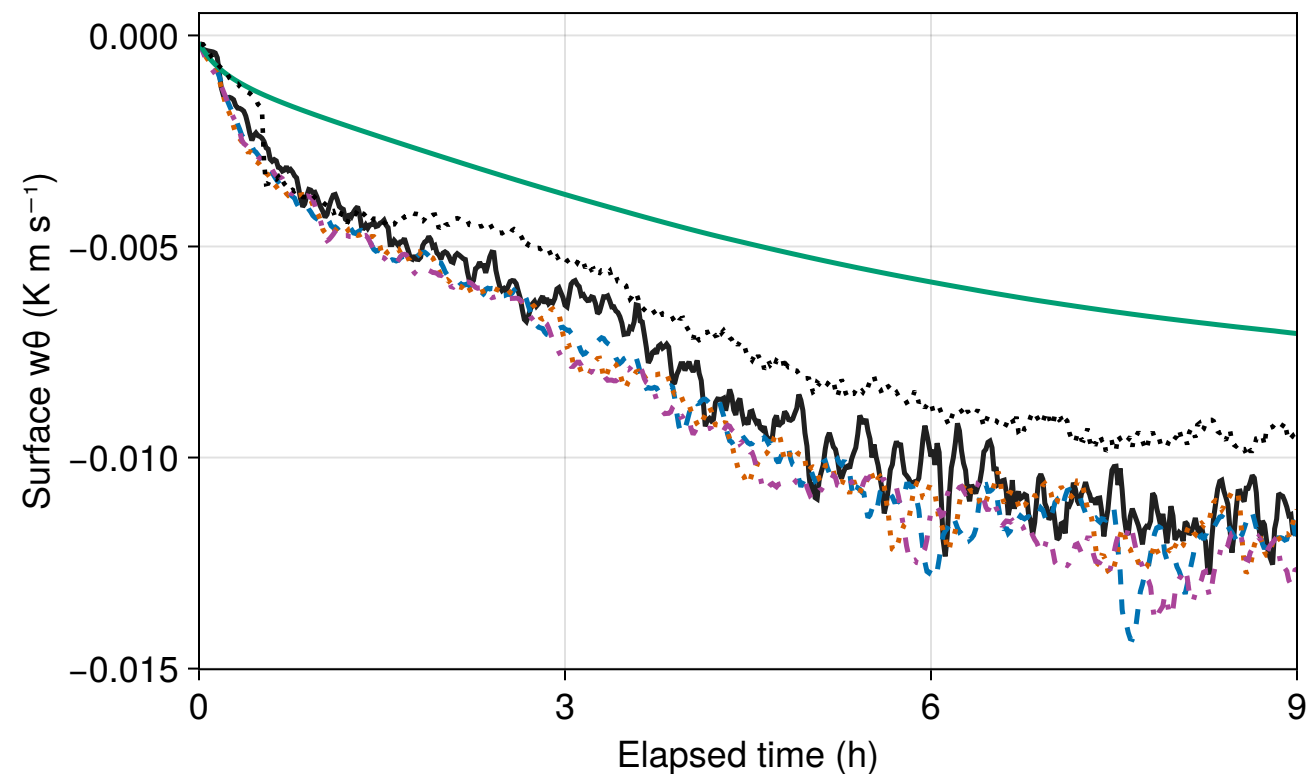
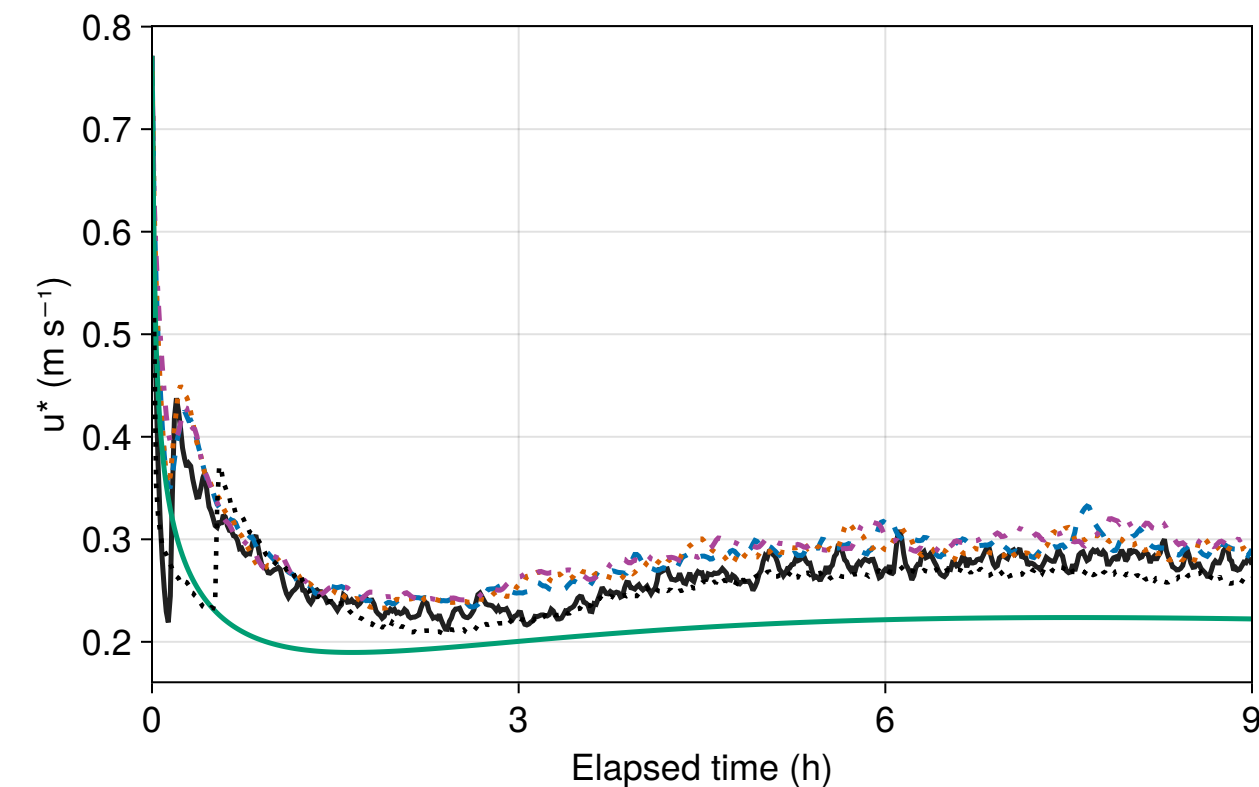
Third moment: the near-wall sign changes



Teal stars: earlier Smagorinsky source; its w^2 and w^3 nearly coincide with zero on these linear axes.
Black dotted: fixed 1 m LES median. SLD SGS/combined flux and dependent diagnostics are withheld.

Follow the response beyond the mean profile

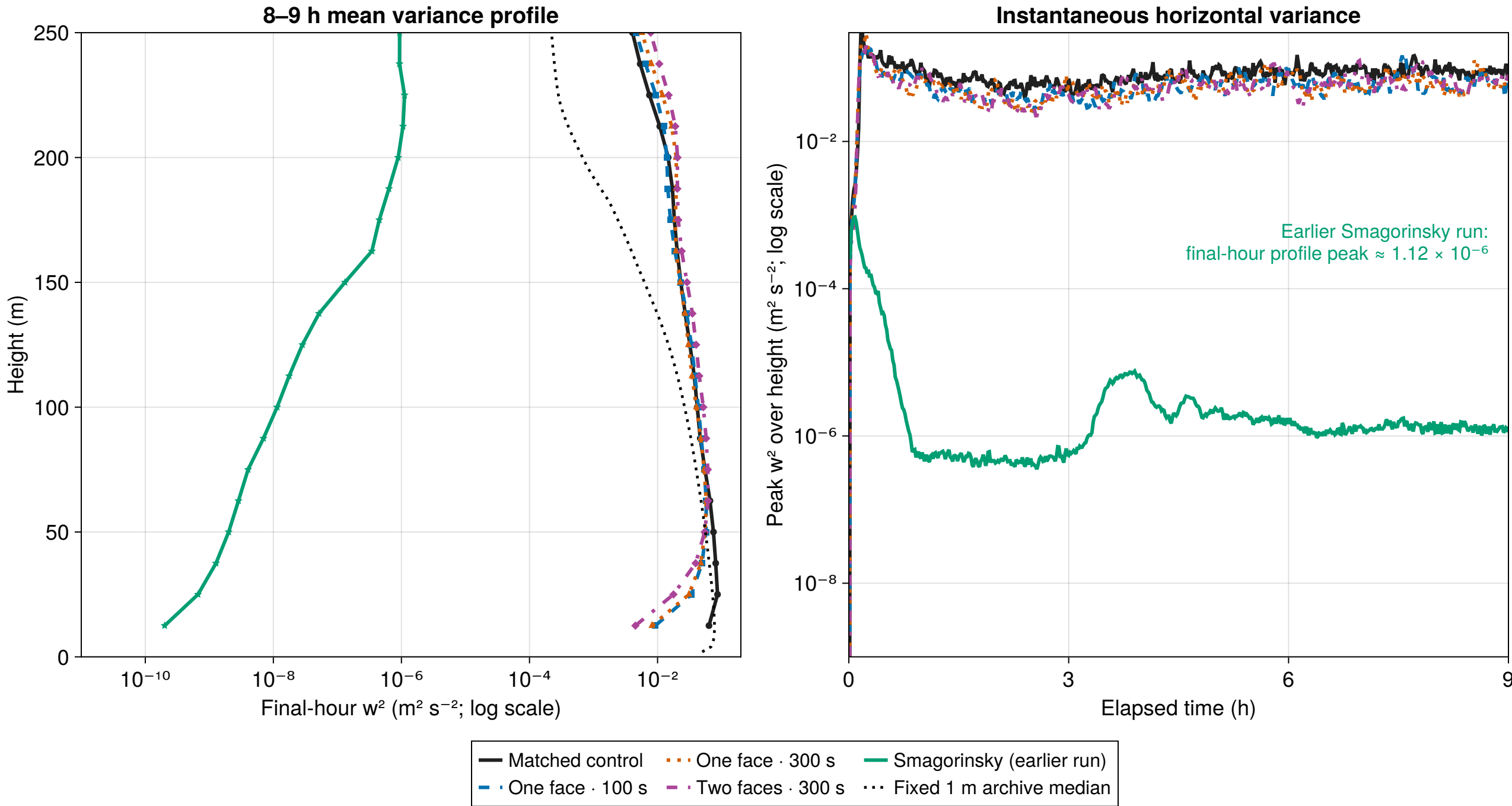
Surface exchange through 9 h; skewness from the final-hour native-face moments



Wall flux remains usable; resolved TKE excludes SGS energy. Teal: earlier Smagorinsky source.
Skewness omits $w^2 < 10^{-6} \text{ m}^2 \text{s}^{-2}$, masking most Smagorinsky levels; a ratio of tiny moments is not robust.

Smagorinsky nearly eliminates resolved vertical turbulence

12.5 m GABLS1 · WENO9 · log axes expose the difference hidden by linear scales



Same grid and advection; Smagorinsky is historical context, not a same-revision controlled treatment.
Zeros are omitted on log axes. The left panel averages first; the right panel takes each instantaneous maximum.